COMMUNITY SAFETY DESK · JEFFREYS BAY

WAVEWATCH USER GUIDE

Hannes, this is your private desk for every safety report in town. You log what comes in, link it into cases and operations, and WaveWatch shows the patterns and writes the reports for the watch and SAPS.

Prepared by Franco Megannon · 20 October 2026 · Proof-of-concept version

Start with the demo data so you can try every feature without risk, then remove it and begin with real records. The whole guide takes about ten minutes to read.

1. GETTING IN

You need a free Claude account on the same email address the invitation was sent to.

1. Open the invitation email and accept it. Sign in to Claude with that exact address.
2. Open WaveWatch from the link. On your phone, open it in the browser and add it to your home screen so it opens like an app.
3. Check the label at the top right. **Private · saved** means your work is stored. **Read-only** means you were invited without edit rights; ask Franco to set you to **Can edit**.

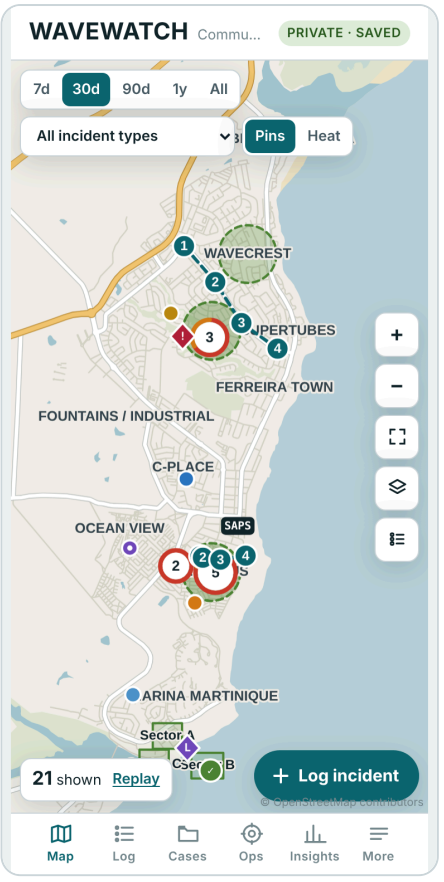
WORKS FOR YOU	RUNS FROM FRANCO'S ACCOUNT FOR NOW
Logging incidents, reports, cases, cameras, operations and patrols	AI extraction of WhatsApp chat exports (Import)
Map, patterns, near-repeat alerts, response times, patrol planner	AI writing of the brief and bulletin, and Ask WaveWatch
SAPS summaries, case packs, footage requests, after-action reports	Live list of who is viewing an operation, and comments
The brief and resident bulletin drafts written without AI	

Where an AI button is greyed out, the version without AI still works. Send Franco the chat export or question and he runs the AI part.

2. THE SIX TABS

TAB	WHAT YOU DO THERE
Map	See incidents, case routes, operations and patrol areas on the town's streets. Switch between pins and a heat map, pick 7 days to all time, and press Replay to watch the last weeks unfold. Long-press anywhere to log an incident at that spot.
Log	Two lists: **Incidents** (what happened) and the **Reports feed** (raw messages as they came in, graded for reliability).
Cases	Investigations that link several incidents, sightings and camera checks into one pack for SAPS.
Ops	Live responses: collisions, medical calls, fires, searches. Also the **Patrol planner**.
Insights	Ask questions, patterns, weekly brief and bulletin, response times, SAPS follow-ups and station statistics.
More	Import WhatsApp messages, cameras, sources, contacts, demo data, exports and settings.

The layers button on the map (the stacked squares) turns incidents, case routes, operations, patrols and cameras on and off. The list button shows the colour key.



Map with demo data: numbered case routes, an active operation, patrol areas.

3. YOUR ROUTINE

EVERY DAY (5 MINUTES)

☐ Log anything new from the WhatsApp groups and control rooms (Log → Log incident, or Add report).

☐ Clear the Reports feed: link each new report to an incident, case or operation, or dismiss it with a reason.

☐ Glance at the near-repeat alerts in Insights → Patterns. Warn the affected streets if one appears.

EVERY WEEK

☐ Insights → Briefs: copy the weekly brief for the committee and the resident bulletin for the community group.

☐ Ops → Patrol planner: copy the patrol plan for the watch, and log the patrols that were done.

☐ Insights → SAPS liaison: chase follow-ups that are due and crimes not yet reported.

☐ Open each active case: update camera checks, tasks and the footage request.

EVERY MONTH AND QUARTER

☐ Build the monthly report (Insights → SAPS liaison) for the watch meeting or station commander.

☐ Enter the station's quarterly figures in Insights → SAPS stats when SAPS releases them.

☐ Run the retention clean-up in More → Data and save a backup.

4. LOGGING INCIDENTS AND REPORTS

LOG AN INCIDENT

1. Press **Log incident** (or long-press the map).
2. Pick what happened, then the time. If you only know a window, fill in **From** and **Until** (for example 00:00 to 05:00).
3. Choose the area and type the street. The pin drops on the street; tap the small map to move it. No house numbers.
4. For break-ins, add the method of entry and items taken.
5. Describe what happened. Describe people by behaviour, clothing and build only. If you type a phone, ID or registration number, WaveWatch warns you and removes it with one tap.
6. Pick the source and, if it belongs to a case or operation, link it.
7. Fill in the SAPS status and CAS number when you have them, and a follow-up date if needed.

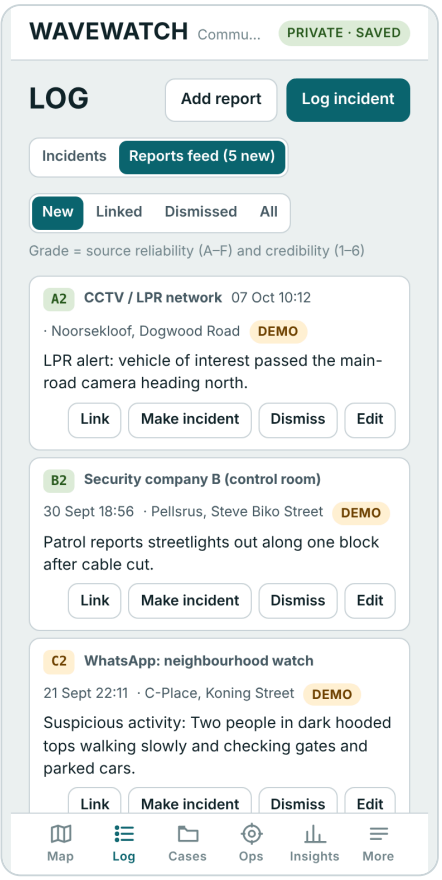
After saving, WaveWatch tells you if the incident is a **near-repeat** (close in place and time to another one) or a **possible match with an open case**. Open the incident to link it with one tap. **Copy SAPS summary** on any incident gives a clean referral text for the station.

THE REPORTS FEED AND GRADING

A report is a raw message as it arrived: a WhatsApp post, a control-room alert, a camera result. Each gets a two-part grade, so a first-hand camera result counts for more than a forwarded rumour.

SOURCE RELIABILITY	REPORT CREDIBILITY
A Completely reliable (own camera, SAPS)	1 Confirmed by another source
B Usually reliable (control room, known member)	2 Probably true
C Fairly reliable	3 Possibly true
D Not usually reliable	4 Doubtful
E Unreliable	5 Improbable
F Cannot be judged	6 Cannot be judged

For each new report choose **Link**, **Make incident** or **Dismiss**. Set each source's default grade once in More → Sources.



Reports feed: grade, source, time and actions.

IMPORTING WHATSAPP MESSAGES

In More → Import, paste messages or open a chat export (.txt or .zip). **Clean and preview** replaces private senders with "Member 1, 2..." and removes phone, ID and registration numbers on your device. Security call signs

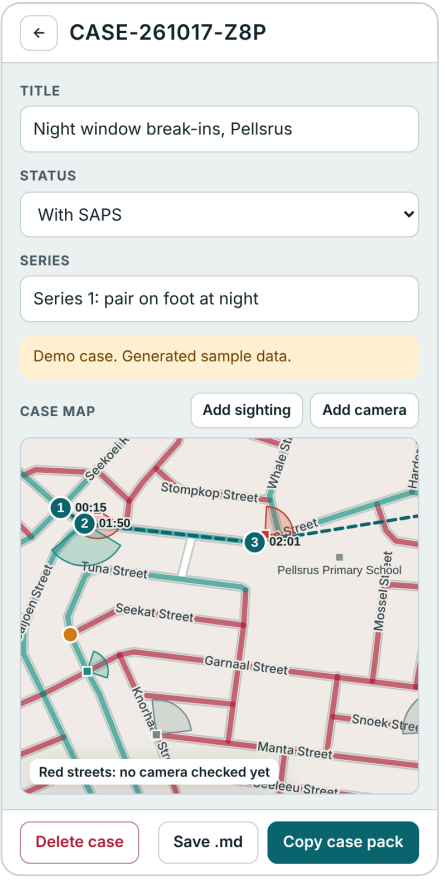
keep their names. With AI available, **Extract** splits the chat into incidents and reports for you to review before saving.

5. WORKING A CASE

Start a case when several incidents look connected (Cases → New case). Give cases the same **series** name when you believe the same people are behind them.

- **Subjects:** describe unidentified people, for example "Pair A: two on foot, dark hooded tops, grey bag". Never names.
- **Sightings:** press Add sighting, tap the map, enter the time. The map draws a numbered route with times.
- **Likely exit routes:** from the direction of the last sightings, WaveWatch ranks the streets ahead (dashed amber on the map) and shows which cameras there are not yet asked.
- **Camera canvass:** set each nearby camera to asked, nothing seen, footage received or handed to SAPS. Streets with no camera checked turn red.
- **Footage window:** if a confirmed sighting falls outside the requested times, you get a warning to widen it.
- **Write footage request:** copies a WhatsApp message with the right time window, the subject description and the streets still needed.
- **Suggested incidents:** unlinked incidents that match this case, with the reasons and a Link button.
- **Tasks, hypotheses and evidence handover:** track next steps, ideas you are testing, and who holds each original clip and who received a copy.

Copy case pack gives the detective one readable summary: incidents, subjects, route, camera register, gaps and handovers.

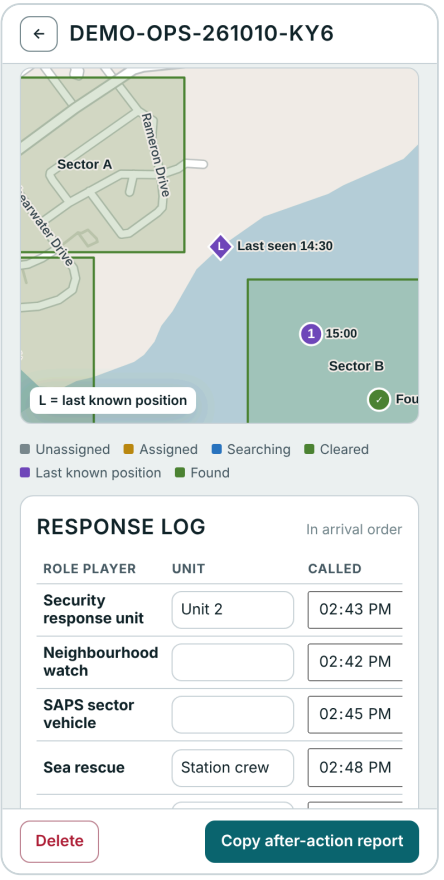


A case: route, cameras by status, red gap streets.

6. RUNNING AN OPERATION

Use an operation for anything with several responders: a collision, medical call, fire, missing person or water rescue (Ops → New operation).

- **Response log:** add each role player as they are called. Press **Now** when they arrive. Response times calculate themselves.
- **Timeline:** add short updates as things happen. While an operation is active, updates also appear live to Franco and anyone else viewing it.
- **Search mode** (missing person, water): set the last known position, add sightings, and **Draw sector** by tapping the corners of each search area. Assign each sector and mark it searching, then cleared. Mark **Found here** at the end.
- **Person details** for a search are allowed while it is active and are removed automatically when you close the operation.
- **Lessons** and **Copy after-action report** give the arrival order, response times, sectors and timeline, without personal details.

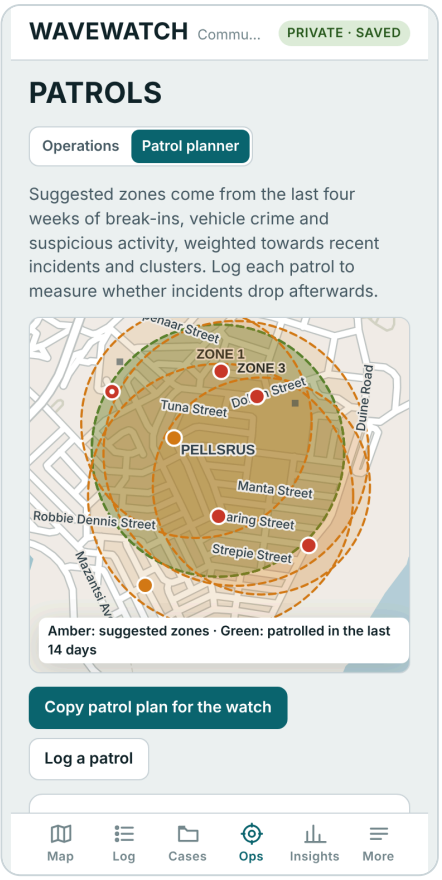


A search: last known position, sectors, found point.

7. PATROL PLANNER

Ops → Patrol planner suggests up to four zones from the last four weeks of break-ins, vehicle crime and suspicious activity, weighted towards recent incidents and clusters.

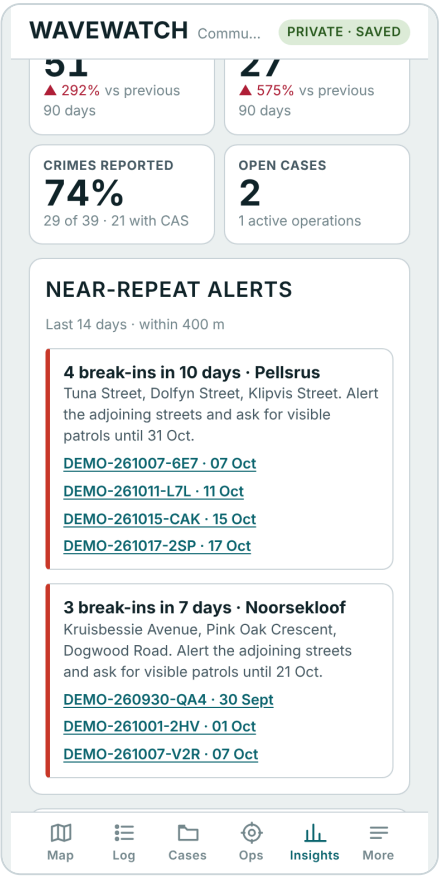
- Each zone shows the streets, the best time window and days, near-repeats and linked cases.
- **Copy patrol plan for the watch** gives a ready WhatsApp message with zones, windows and what to look out for.
- **Log patrol** after each patrol: zone, times, team and notes. Patrolled areas show green on the map for 14 days.
- **Did patrols help?** compares incidents in each zone for the same number of days before and after the first patrol. Small numbers swing a lot, so treat it as a talking point, not proof.



Suggested zones in amber, patrolled areas in green.

8. INSIGHTS

SECTION	USE IT FOR
Ask	Plain-language questions answered from the records, with refs. For example "Which area had the most break-ins this month, and when?"
Patterns	Headline numbers, near-repeat alerts, weekly trend, area by time-of-day grid, days, methods, sources and repeat locations.
Briefs	The **intelligence brief** for the committee and station, and the **resident bulletin** for the community group. The bulletin names suburbs and times only and warns you if a street or number slips in.
Response times	Median time from call to arrival for each type of responder, and time to first responder for each operation.
SAPS liaison	Follow-ups due, crimes not yet reported, CAS cases awaiting feedback, and the monthly report.
SAPS stats	Enter the station's quarterly figures by category. WaveWatch compares them with what it logged and shows the capture rate, which points to crime residents are not reporting to the watch, or to SAPS.



Patterns: weekly trend and the when-and-where grid.

9. PRIVACY RULES

WaveWatch records **events and descriptions**, never identities. This keeps the watch a credible partner for SAPS and within POPIA.

ALWAYS

- Describe people by behaviour, clothing and build.
- Use street names, never house numbers.
- Leave footage with its owner and record the handover.
- Pass identified suspects and registration numbers straight to SAPS.
- Close operations when they end, so personal details are removed.

NEVER

- Names of suspects, residents or patients.
- Phone, ID or registration numbers.
- Nationality, race, language or religion.
- Medical details beyond "injured, transported".
- Photos of people, or footage posted in groups.

10. FIRST-TIME SETUP WITH REAL DATA

1. **Try the demo.** More → Data → Load demo data. Everything is marked DEMO. Explore every tab.
2. **Remove the demo.** More → Data → Remove demo data (tap twice to confirm).
3. **Fix the area centres.** More → Data → Areas. Four centres are estimates: Supertubes, Fountains / Industrial, Ocean View and Tokyo Sexwale. Tap **Set centre** and tap the middle of each area.
4. **Add your sources.** More → Sources. Add each security company, camera network and WhatsApp group by name with a default grade, and the role players you work with (ambulance services, sea rescue, municipal teams).
5. **Register cameras** you know of (More → Cameras): position, direction, owner organisation and how many days the footage is kept.
6. **Add contacts** (More → Contacts): the station, sector vehicle, control rooms and watch leaders. Organisations and desks only.
7. **Log for four weeks.** After four weeks of real use, we review together whether to move WaveWatch to its own web app for the wider watch.

Backups: More → Data → Backup (.json) saves everything. Keep a copy monthly. The same file moves your data into the future web app.

Questions or problems? Contact Franco. Report anything that looks wrong with a screenshot and the time it happened.

WaveWatch User Guide · Proof-of-concept version, 20 October 2026 · Screens show generated demo data. Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors.